CRACKING THE CHEAT CODE

How authorities are unravelling recruitment exam fraud





1. Digital Sleuth: The Special Operations Group and Anti-Terrorism Squad now use AI, biometrics and data analytics to trace impersonators and forged records

2. The Big Re-check: The Education Department has begun re-verifying medical and academic certificates

lost lakhs they had paid for question papers. Among them, constable Radhika Singh, posted with Jaipur rural police, was held for buying the papers for Rs 14 lakh. She then read them out to fellow aspirant Praveen Kumar Kharadi outside the exam hall. She cleared the written exam, but failed in the interview; Kharadi got selected, but now faces prosecution.

Investigators have also found that at least 15 of those selected had already cleared the tougher RAS exam, highlighting how the cancellation of the SI exam penalised deserving candidates.

RESERVATION RUSE

When BJP MLA Shankar Singh Rawat from Beawar was accused of helping his daughter-in-law Sunita Devi secure a teacher's job under the divorced women quota—despite living with her husband—more such cases surfaced. Constable Kavita was found to have used false divorce papers to get her post. Over 50 women employees are now under investigation, many of whom are either still living with, or have remarried, the husbands they claimed to have divorced. Police say such forgeries are difficult to prosecute because they require proving cohabitation.

The allegations against the four-term MLA don't end here. His daughter, Kanchan Chauhan, who became a naib tehsildar in 2024 under the disability quota, was later found to have falsely claimed over 40 per cent deafness when she was only 8 per cent hard of hearing. Rawat claims his political rivals have filed false complaints against his family.

The government has now ordered the re-examination of all employees recruited under the disability quota. Of the 44 verified so far, 38 were found to have wrong certifications. Some papers carried fake doctor signatures; in others, doctors themselves were complicit. In Sirohi, a probe found that a former chief medical and health officer had issued 5,177 disability certificates between 2019 and 2025 using a single doctor's name across multiple specialties, and even citing the doctors who were never posted there.

IN AUGUST, THE HIGH COURT CANCELLED THE 2021 POLICE SI RECRUITMENT PROCESS AFTER WIDESPREAD EVIDENCE OF PAPER LEAKS AND PROXY CANDIDATES; NEARLY 797,000 CANDIDATES HAD COMPETED FOR 859 POSTS

FAKING DEGREES

The education department is investigating 4,500 Physical Training Instructors (PTIs) recruited after the 2022 exam following complaints that many had submitted forged or backdated degrees. So far, over 300 FIRs have been registered and 134 employees dismissed. The SOG has arrested PTI Suman Kumar posted in Rajsamand district and her husband, and another recruit, Saurav Kalal, from Banswara district, for using fake backdated degrees to qualify for selection.

The fraud goes even deeper. Aditya Yadav from Tijara, who never studied beyond Class 12, was arrested for using a fake B.Tech degree to obtain an assistant engineer's post in the 2022 RPSC recruitment, where he even ranked seventh. His 'degree', arranged from Ahmedabad by a middleman, was part of a wider racket involving multiple universities across Rajasthan, Haryana and Gujarat.

In another case, one Saurabh Singh from Haryana was arrested for supplying forged mark-sheets and certificates. His e-Mitra centre in Rewari produced fake documents complete with forged QR codes and university seals, and sold those to jobless youths through local agents. The racket spanned Rajasthan, Haryana, Punjab and Madhya Pradesh.

The probe has revealed newer layers of forgery. In September, the Anti-